



AVERT Code of Conduct

Introduction

The AVERT (Addressing Violent Extremism and Radicalisation to Terrorism) Research Network is committed to transparency and ethical conduct. The Network and its members believe in conducting meaningful evidence-based research for the public good, rigorous and constructive dialogue and critique, and respect for different perspectives and viewpoints.

This Code of Conduct is intended to establish the standards of collegial conduct expected of all Network Members, and to detail procedures for any violation of these standards for AVERT research members and expectations for participants in AVERT sponsored events.

Values

The guiding principles of AVERT, which underpin its policies, are:

- Maintaining a genuine and inclusive consortium of demonstrated research experts and contributors across academia, civil society, and government;
- Supporting new and emerging researchers and expertise;
- Promoting equality of opportunity and inclusion;
- Commitment to academic freedom and human rights;
- Facilitating cross-sector and multidisciplinary collaboration;
- Demonstrating transparency, trust and respect in how we engage with all colleagues, stakeholders, partners and members of the general public;
- Commitment to rigorous, ethical, evidence-based research and practice, and,
- Sharing, exchange and dialogue on new knowledge and outcomes.

Applicability

This Code of Conduct applies to AVERT members in all professional situations, including when engaging in public forums and other public contexts that reflect on the AVERT Research Network. It also applies to all participants in AVERT-sponsored events.

Standards of Conduct

Members of AVERT and participants in AVERT-sponsored events will:

- 1) Act with integrity, courtesy and respect towards fellow AVERT members, and towards members of other professions and the broader community;
- 2) Ensure that participant interactions are respectful, fair, and free of discrimination and harassment;
- 3) Constructively critique and ensure that disagreement remains respectful;
- 4) When applicable, maintain confidentiality of AVERT proceedings and deliberations, and,

Assist those who find themselves in harmful situations, such as victims of harassment and discrimination at AVERT events, to the best of their abilities.

Members of the AVERT, and participants in AVERT-sponsored events, will not:

- 1) Discriminate or vilify based on personal attributes (i.e., gender, race, ethnicity, orientation, etc.) or violate another's human rights;
- 2) Engage in, encourage, or condone unacceptable behaviour (see definition below);
- 3) Knowingly or carelessly act in a manner that causes harm to the professional integrity or equal opportunity of others;
- 4) Knowingly or carelessly act in a manner that endangers the safety or security of others, including engaging in harassment, abuse, threats, violence, etc.;
- 5) Distribute or disseminate contents of presentations, posters or imagery of others without their consent (active consent must be sought and given for attendees at AVERT events to be photographed or videoed), or,
- 6) Retaliate against anyone because of their contribution to or participation in an event, or seek to influence participation through intimidating language or behaviour.
- 7) Research members will also uphold relevant research codes of conduct in the course of their research activities.

Unacceptable behaviour

Unacceptable behaviour includes, but is not limited to, disrespectful, humiliating, disruptive, violent, abusive, harassing or intimidating conduct, and exclusionary or discriminatory comments.

Reporting and action

Reports of behaviour that may be considered to breach the Code of Conduct can be made, by AVERT members or non-members, to one or both of the Co-convenors. Any report will be handled confidentially and according to principles of procedural fairness. The Executive Committee will be responsible for determining whether an AVERT member or non-member has breached this Code of Conduct.

Co-convenors and members of the Executive Committee must declare any conflict of interest, arising from professional, personal or financial relationships, and recuse themselves from the process described below.

Co-convenors may make an interim decision to:

- a. discuss the matter in an educative manner with the reported person and/or attempt mediation;
- b. advise non-members or members that they may not attend AVERT events; and/or
- c. suspend membership prior to the Executive meeting.

On receiving a report, the convenor(s) will:

- a. add a discussion of the report to the agenda of the next Executive Committee meeting;
- b. advise the Executive of any interim decision; and

- c. Provide evidence that the reporting person has supplied to the coordinator for circulation to Executive Committee members.

The Co-convenors must acknowledge receipt of the complaint and give the person whose conduct was reported written notice of the report at least 14 days before the Executive Committee meeting at discussion of their conduct is to take place.

The notice given to the person must state:

- a. when the Executive meeting is to be held; and
- b. the grounds on which the report was made; and
- c. that the reported person, or their representative, may make written submission to the Executive in response to the report.

At the Committee meeting, the Executive Committee must:

- a. give due consideration to any submissions so made;
- b. decide whether to take further action, or if an educative approach or mediation undertake by convenors is deemed to have sufficiently addressed the matter;
- a. decide whether or not to censure, suspend or expel a member from AVERT, and whether or not to advise the reported person they may not attend future AVERT events; and
- b. decide whether or not the conduct may be considered a breach of relevant codes of research ethics and therefore whether it should be appropriately reported to the member's institution.

Appeals following any decision may be made if additional information becomes available.

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